

July

23

2010

One Direction

After five teenagers appeared separately on UK talent show *The X Factor*, they were brought together as boy band One Direction by judge Simon Cowell. They quickly became one of the world's most popular pop groups.



Also on this day

1952 The almost 150-year reign of the Muhammad Ali Dynasty in Egypt ended when the army overthrew King Farouk and established a republic.

1980 Vietnamese astronaut **Pham Tuân** became the first non-Soviet Asian to go into space, on board Soviet spacecraft *Soyuz 37*.

2015 NASA scientists announced the discovery of **Kepler-452b**, an Earthlike planet in the habitable zone of a Sunlike star.



Full speed ahead

US former military pilot Don Wetzel tested the rocket-powered *Black Beetle* train. Speeding along a flat, straight track, it reached a top speed of 296 kph (183 mph) – an unbeaten US railway record.

1966

Born this day

1931 **Te Atairangikaahu**, Māori queen. Her 40-year rule made her the longest-reigning Māori monarch.

1989 **Daniel Radcliffe**, British actor. He starred as Harry Potter in the film adaptations of J K Rowling's novels.

2012

Cycling record

The first woman to set a record for cycling around the globe, British-German endurance athlete Juliana Buhring began her journey in Naples, Italy. She finished 152 days later, after travelling more than 29,000 km (18,000 miles) on a bicycle.

